

The KRA channel — worked to the bottom

Your lunch opened a real lane. Here is everyone, everything, and exactly what to say Monday — with every claim labeled for how solid it is.

01 · STATE OF PLAY

What your lunch achieved — with one correction

- **KRA wants to collaborate in Alberta** — gate: a healthcare portfolio showing past relevant experience per consultant (you + Ian are building it).
- **They handed us a lane, unprompted:** "a nice spot for commissioning, because others don't want to do it" — then proved it: they hired a Toronto firm *they didn't know* (Stephenson) because no Vancouver structural engineer would take the work.
- **The correction that sharpens everything:** KRA has **no Alberta office and no Alberta-based staff** — their 43-person roster is Vancouver; Alberta work runs on Kirsten Reite's personal Alberta license. Your lunch guest was a traveler. So "she'll be in Vancouver in 2 weeks" almost certainly means *she's going home* — and the meeting is at their headquarters, with the whole firm reachable in one room.

WHO YOU LIKELY MET

Sheila Mackay — Director of Market Development

(sheila.mackay@krarchitecture.ca) — the only business-development leadership title on KRA's roster; a healthcare-BD veteran active in the hospital-facilities circuit. *Held at medium confidence: her base city couldn't be verified from primary sources. Confirm Monday — simply ask where she's based.*

02 • THE REFRAME

"Commissioning" isn't what it sounds like — and that's the opportunity

	PEER REVIEW	COMMISSIONING (CX)
When	During design	End of construction → opening
What	Independent engineer reviews <i>another firm's</i> design	Verifying the <i>built</i> facility performs as designed
In healthcare	Owner-driven on major projects	CSA Z8001 program — mech/elec-led, a de facto funding condition in BC

THE MARKET FACT THAT CHANGES THE PITCH

CSA Z8001 explicitly excludes structural systems from commissioning scope. Seismic verification runs through the separate Letters-of-Assurance / field-review regime, and no BC health authority procures the seismic-restraint / equipment-anchorage slice as a line item at all. "Nobody wants to do it" is literally true — *it isn't even a defined trade*. KOR wouldn't be competing for a scope; KOR would be **naming one**: structural & seismic verification around the commissioning program (restraint and anchorage sign-off, equipment-swap assessments in live facilities, vibration checks for imaging/ORs).

- **Market fluency for your pocket:** the real Cx players on BC health capital are **HH Angus** (Toronto — recurring, MEP-side), **CES Group** (owner's commissioning lead on the \$2.2B New St. Paul's), and **Zenith** (the BC boutique). Cx is normally bundled inside the design-build/alliance team; only megaprojects hire it owner-direct. *There is no standing-offer roster* — relationships decide.

03 • KRA, PRECISELY

Where their work actually is

PROJECT	KRA ROLE	STATUS (VERIFIED 2026-07-03)	MEANS FOR US
Prince Albert Victoria Hospital, SK	Prime consultant	50% built, opens 2028 — structural EOR is Entuitive	The live commissioning window (2027–28) — the pilot to ask for
New Edmonton Hospital (~\$3.9B)	"Compliance"-labeled role, not lead architect	ON HOLD — 2026 AB budget funds planning only, no construction money for 3 years	Long game — don't build the pitch on it
Burnaby Hospital Ph 1, BC	Unconfirmed	Completing 2026	Ask — nearest-term BC completion
Chinook Regional Hospital, AB	Associate architect (under Perkins+Will/Group2)	Completed 2016 — legacy credit	Careful: the current Chinook dialysis expansion belongs to a different firm (McKay Hlavacek) — don't conflate

- **Consultant habits:** no single structural go-to across their portfolio (Entuitive on the flagship; RJC on Alberta legacy under other leads) — the door is genuinely open, no entrenched incumbent to displace at KRA itself.

KRA PERSON	ROLE	EMAIL
Sheila Mackay	Director of Market Development — likely your contact & the Vancouver BD intro	sheila.mackay@krarchitecture.ca
Kirsten Reite	Owner/Principal — holds the Alberta license personally	kirsten@krarchitecture.ca
Lila Kumi	Business Development Coordinator	lila@krarchitecture.ca
Renaude Laberge-Boisjoli	Senior Architect	renaude@krarchitecture.ca

All addresses found by domain search at 96–99 confidence ({first}@pattern). Earlier intel named associate principals (Gagnon, Verville, Madley) — some don't appear on today's staff page; possible turnover, don't lead with those names.

04 • STEPHENSON

Know who they actually hired

Stephenson Engineering, Toronto — a company of **Salas O'Brien** (US roll-up, 40+ mergers; platform = engineering + commissioning). That's why they say yes where Vancouver firms say no.

THE TWIST

Their "Vancouver office" is **inherited MEP turf from the 2023 Crossey Engineering merger** — one MEP associate, a 416 contact number, no structural or commissioning bench in BC that public records show. Their BC health credits (Royal Columbian, New Surrey/BC Cancer, Dawson Creek) are all Crossey *MEP design*. No public CSA Z8001 healthcare-commissioning project anywhere — capability is marketing-claimed, not project-shown.

NAME TO KNOW	ROLE	WHERE	CONTACT
Aron McCallum	Managing Principal	Toronto	amccallum@stephenson-eng.com <i>(verified)</i>
Lawrence McSorley	Principal, Building Science — deep government relationships in Western Canada	Calgary	lmcsorley@stephenson-eng.com · 403-648-0033 x314
Christian Guimond	VP / office leader (structural, building science, envelope)	Ottawa	<i>pattern only, unverified</i>
Daniel Hofland	Associate, MEP (ex-Crossey) — the only Vancouver-based name found	Vancouver	<i>pattern only, unverified</i>

- **Their weakness in one line:** fly-in delivery — no BC structural bench, no public BC seismic depth, visible post-merger friction, and a brand blur between Stephenson (structural) and Crossey (MEP) that one polite question exposes.
- **The diligence question to plant:** *"Was your commissioning handled by Stephenson's structural people in Toronto, or the ex-Crossey mechanical team?"* — the answer maps the exact scope to pitch.

05 • MONDAY

The follow-up script

1

Scope + who

"What exactly did Stephenson do for you — which projects, and was it the mechanical program or the structural side (restraints, anchorage, vibration)?" And confirm: is she based in Vancouver?

2

Lock the meeting

Propose a specific slot at their Vancouver office, and ask who joins from their side (if she IS the BD lead, the "intro" is already made — aim for Reite in the room).

3

Name the pilot

"Prince Albert opens in 2028 — who's doing your structural and seismic verification through completion? We'd love to price that scope." The bar question: what would it take to give the next one to a Vancouver firm?

- **Take the Toronto favour:** your friend's read on what Stephenson's commissioning actually covered is intel we can't get publicly. Yes please.
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06 • HONEST LABELS

What's solid and what isn't

- **Solid (primary-sourced):** KRA's no-Alberta-office roster; New Edmonton Hospital on hold with KRA in a compliance-labeled role; Prince Albert prime role, 50% complete, Entuitive structural; Z8001's structural exclusion; Stephenson corporate facts, Crossey lineage, and BC MEP credits; all named contacts.
 - **Medium:** Mackay as your lunch contact (best-fit inference — confirm); Burnaby Ph 1 role; Zenith's exact scopes.
 - **Her words only (single-source):** that Stephenson did KRA's commissioning, and that Stephenson "just started" a Vancouver presence — the public record shows only the inherited MEP office. Question 1 settles both.
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KOR Structural — Confidential / Internal · Prepared 2026-07-03 for Islam · Four research passes; contacts verified where domains allow; corrections welcome after Monday's call. Everything filed in the BD database.